

DISABILITY SUPPORT INFORMATION: NOVA SCOTIA

Before You Send This | Alberta Disability Refugee Series | April 2026

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This page summarizes disability support, housing, health, and travel rules for people considering relocation to this province. Amounts are approximate. Rules change. Always confirm directly with the provincial government before making any decisions.

DISABILITY SUPPORT PROGRAM -- NOVA SCOTIA

Program Name:	Disability Support Program (DSP)
Administered By:	NS Department of Community Services
Monthly Benefit:	Approximately \$950/month
Benefit Notes:	Rates vary by living situation. DSP also provides in-home supports and community services beyond the income supplement.
Employment Required?	NO -- No employment requirement under the NS Disability Support Program.
CDB Clawback?	NO -- Nova Scotia does not claw back the federal Canada Disability Benefit.
Re-Diagnosis Required?	Yes -- NS DSP requires its own disability determination. Prior AISH documentation is supporting evidence. Processing time varies.
Appeal Rights:	Social Assistance Appeal Board -- independent

HOUSING AND COST OF LIVING

Major Cities:	Halifax, Dartmouth, Truro, Sydney (Cape Breton), Kentville
Average 1BR Rent:	\$1,600-\$2,000/mo (Halifax) \$1,100-\$1,500 (smaller centres)
Rent Note:	Halifax rents have risen sharply. The DSP benefit does not cover Halifax rent alone. Smaller NS communities are more viable.
Rent Control?	NS introduced rent caps. Annual increases are currently limited. Check current Residential Tenancies Act for updated limits.
Subsidized Waitlist:	Halifax: 2-5 year waits for subsidized housing. Smaller communities have better availability.
Social Housing:	Housing Nova Scotia; Affordable Living Tax Credit; Community Housing; long waitlists in Halifax.

HEALTH, MEDICAL, AND TRAVEL RULES

3-Month Health Gap:	Up to 3 months with no MSI coverage. Register with MSI (Medical Services Insurance) on Day 1.
Health Coverage:	Nova Scotia Health Authority. MSI for medical. Pharmacare available income-tested. Dental limited for adults.
Medical Supplies:	Check NS Pharmacare formulary. Some DSP recipients have access to additional supply coverage. Confirm before assuming coverage.
Transit/Paratransit:	Halifax Transit with Access-A-Bus paratransit in HRM. Rural transit is minimal -- vehicle near-essential outside Halifax.
Driver's License:	90 days to exchange your Alberta license in Nova Scotia.
Vehicle Registration:	Register within 90 days of establishing NS residency.

BEFORE YOU APPLY -- IMPORTANT:

Apply to DSP upon establishing NS residency. Research specific communities outside Halifax -- the benefit rate is low relative to Halifax rents.

YOUR RIGHTS UNDER THE CANADIAN CHARTER OF RIGHTS AND FREEDOMS

Plain Language Summary | Alberta Disability Refugee Series | April 2026

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The Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms is part of Canada's Constitution. It protects the rights of every person in Canada. Three sections apply directly to disabled Albertans being financially forced out of their province by the ADAP transition.

SECTION 6 -- MOBILITY RIGHTS: YOUR RIGHT TO MOVE

"Every citizen of Canada has the right to move to and take up residence in any province."

- You have a constitutional right to leave Alberta and move to any other province. No law can take that away.
- Other provinces can require a short residency period (usually 3 months) before you access local programs, but they cannot block you from arriving.
- The argument: When the ADAP transition leaves someone without enough money to pay for the move -- transport, first and last month rent, deposits -- it creates a financial barrier that effectively traps people. A right you cannot afford to use is a right being denied.
- Financial destitution caused by government policy can be argued as a violation of Section 6. This is part of why documenting your financial reality matters.

SECTION 7 -- LIFE, LIBERTY AND SECURITY OF THE PERSON

"Everyone has the right to life, liberty and security of the person."

- The Supreme Court of Canada has said Section 7 may protect against government actions that threaten your ability to survive -- including cutting income that covers food, shelter, and medication.
- If moving from AISH to ADAP causes serious physical or psychological harm because the income is no longer sufficient to live on, this may be a Section 7 violation.
- Section 7 also requires that when the government takes something from you, it must follow basic rules of fairness -- including the right to be heard and the right to appeal.
- Removing the independent Citizens Appeal Panel (Bill 12, December 2025) means 79,290 Albertans lost the right to challenge a decision that directly affects their survival. That is a direct challenge to the principles of fundamental justice.

SECTION 15 -- EQUALITY RIGHTS: NO DISCRIMINATION BASED ON DISABILITY

"Every individual is equal before and under the law ... without discrimination based on disability."

- Section 15 is the strongest equality protection for people with disabilities in Canadian law. It applies directly here.
- Creating a two-tier system that sorts disabled people by perceived capacity to work -- and gives those people fewer rights, less money, and no appeal -- may create a disadvantageous distinction based on disability type.
- The people most harmed are those with real, permanent, documented disabilities that do not fit the narrow exemption categories. Section 15 exists precisely to protect them.
- Advocates argue that the ADAP transition treats some disabled people as less worthy of stable support than others -- based entirely on a government assessment of employment potential. That is discrimination.

DAY 1 TO DAY 90 -- WHAT TO DO WHEN YOU ARRIVE

- Day 1: Apply for your new provincial health card. This starts the 3-month clock. Do not wait.
- Day 1: Begin searching for a family doctor. Doctor shortages are real -- start immediately. Ask about walk-in clinics as a bridge.
- Day 30: File your provincial disability application (PWD/ODSP/SAID depending on province). Bring all Alberta documentation.
- Day 60: Exchange your Alberta driver's license (60-90 day deadline in most provinces). After the deadline you are driving illegally.
- Day 90: Register your vehicle in the new province. Safety inspection required in BC and some others.
- Ongoing: Keep copies of everything. Document every interaction with every government office. Dates, names, reference numbers.

ABOUT ME -- PERSONAL IMPACT STATEMENT

Click any box and replace the example text with your own words. No word limits.

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This section is yours. Write as much or as little as you need. You do not have to share anything you are not comfortable sharing. Each box already has example text. Click into it, select all, and replace it with your own words.

MY DISABILITY AND DAILY LIFE

Describe your disability and how it affects your daily life:

MY DISABILITY AND DAILY LIFE

I have been living with [your primary diagnosis -- for example: fibromyalgia, bipolar disorder type I, multiple sclerosis, spinal cord injury]

PHYSICAL IMPACTS:

My condition affects my body in the following ways on a daily basis: [Choose and complete what applies to you] I cannot sit for more than [X] minutes. I cannot walk for more than [X] minutes. I cannot lift more than [X] pounds. I cannot [X].

MY FINANCIAL REALITY

Describe your current financial situation and what the ADAP transition means for you:

I currently receive \$[your AISH amount, e.g. \$1,685 or \$1,940]/month through AISH. My fixed monthly expenses are as follows:

MY HOUSING SITUATION

Describe your current housing and what relocation would mean for you:

I currently live in [city], Alberta. I have been a resident of Alberta for [X] years. I rent / own [choose one] my current home.

MY DEPENDENTS AND SUPPORT NETWORK

Describe any dependents or others who would be affected:

I [have / do not have] dependents who rely on me. [If yes:] I am the primary caregiver for [describe: my child / my children]

NOTICE OF DISPLACEMENT -- DISABLED ALBERTAN SEEKING INTERPROVINCIAL SUPPORT

To: The Government of Nova Scotia -- Premier Tim Houston and Minister of Community Services

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JULY 1, 2026 -- 82 DAYS FROM DATE OF PUBLICATION

The Province of Alberta is eliminating adequate disability supports for 79,290 Albertans.
I am one of them. I am writing to you because I may have no other option.

STEP 1 -- YOUR AISH INFORMATION

You may leave your name blank to submit anonymously.

Your Full Name (or leave blank to remain anonymous):

Number of years you have been on AISH:

e.g. 10

Your AISH File Number (for government verification):

e.g. 1234567 -- on your AISH correspondence

STEP 2 -- YOUR NOTICE (PRE-WRITTEN -- DO NOT EDIT)

My name is [see above]. I am a Canadian citizen living in Alberta with a permanent disability. I have been receiving Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) for the number of years indicated above. My disability is permanent, documented, and has been assessed by the Government of Alberta as substantially and permanently limiting my ability to earn a livelihood. I am writing to the Government of Nova Scotia because the Province of Alberta is forcing me out. Please refer to my personal impact statement for full details.

This notice engages Sections 6, 7, and 15 of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms.

STEP 3 -- MY TRANSPORTATION SITUATION (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

- ☐ I have a vehicle and may be able to relocate if I can afford the costs.
- ☐ I do not have a vehicle. There are no affordable interprovincial buses. I do not know how I would get there.
- ☐ I have dependents who would travel with me -- children or a family member who also relies on supports.
- ☐ I have medical equipment, mobility aids, or prescriptions that make relocation complex and costly.

**If ADAP proceeds as planned and I am unable to sustain myself in Alberta,
I will arrive in your province with nothing.**

No savings. No employment history. No local support network. A disability assessed as permanent.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

facebook.com/share/g/1CrU5PfHha/

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AISH CONTACT INFO | SEND TO | STEP 4 -- SIGN AND SUBMIT

Alberta Disability Refugee -- Nova Scotia | July 1, 2026

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AISH / ADAP CONTACT INFORMATION FOR GOVERNMENT VERIFICATION

Recipients of this notice may verify the sender's AISH file status by contacting:

Program:	Alberta Disability Assistance Program (AISH / ADAP transition)
Email:	adapengagement@gov.ab.ca
Phone:	1-877-644-9992 (toll-free)
AISH File #:	[as provided by the sender on page 4 of this document]
Authorization:	The sender consents to release of their file status and eligibility history for the purposes of this interprovincial notice.

WHAT I AM ASKING OF YOUR GOVERNMENT

I am not asking for charity. I am a Canadian citizen asking for the following:

- Acknowledge receipt of this notice and the situation it describes.
- Confirm what disability support programs are available to a new resident of Nova Scotia, and what the transition process would look like.
- Raise the situation of Albertans with disabilities in federal-provincial discussions.
- Consider what coordinated interprovincial response is available to Canadians displaced by provincial policy.
- Send a copy of your response to Premier Danielle Smith of Alberta, so she knows her policy decisions are being tracked.

THIS NOTICE IS BEING SENT TO

- Premier Tim Houston -- Government of Nova Scotia premier@novascotia.ca	- Federal Minister of Disability Inclusion hc.ministre-minister.sc@hc-sc.gc.ca
- Minister of Community Services -- Government of Nova Scotia mincs@novascotia.ca	- HUMA Standing Committee -- House of Commons HUMA@parl.gc.ca
- Premier Danielle Smith -- Government of Alberta premier@gov.ab.ca	- Alberta Human Rights Commission humanrights@gov.ab.ca
- Minister Nathan Neudorf -- Alberta Assisted Living & Social Services alss.minister@gov.ab.ca	

STEP 4 -- SIGN AND SUBMIT

Complete all fields, then email this document (including your About Me section) to all recipients above.

Full Name (or 'Submitted Anonymously'):

City / Town, Alberta:

Email Address (optional):

Phone Number (optional):

Date (YYYY-MM-DD):

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